```
// index.php
var_dump($_SERVER['HTTP_CONTENT_TYPE']);
print PHP_EOL;
var_dump(file_get_contents('php://input'));
print PHP_EOL;
var_dump($_POST);
```

... and here's how we can POST some JSON data with curl:

```
$ curl -X 'POST' -H 'Content-Type: application/json' \
  -d '{"animals":[{"cat":"jess"}],"humans":["anna","paul"]}' \
  'http://localhost:8080/index.php'
string(16) "application/json"

string(44) "{"animals":[{"cat":"jess"}],"humans":["anna","paul"]}"

array(0) {
}
```

Notice that the `$_POST` superglobal is now just an empty array because we've set the `Content-Type:` header to `application/json`, and the request data is now the JSON equivalent of the previous form-encoded string. The request body is still available via a `file_get_contents('php://input')` call, but we'll have to manually intervene to turn that string into something we can use in our PHP code. Let's tweak `index.php` a little. We'll make use of PHP's built-in `json_decode()` function...

```
// index.php
$json = file_get_contents('php://input');
$requestData = json_decode($json, true);
var_dump($requestData);
```

... and make our curl request again:

```
$ curl -X 'POST' -H 'Content-Type: application/json' \
  -d '{"animals":[{"cat":"jess"}],"humans":["anna","paul"]}' \
  'http://localhost:8080/index.php'

array(2) {
  ["animals"]=>
  array(1) {
    [0]=>
```